

Spanish A1 — Week 8 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner Spanish | Week 8

Theme: Home, Neighborhood, and Key Irregular Verbs

What You Will Learn This Week

Week 8 has two focuses. Session 15 takes you inside a Spanish-speaking home — rooms, furniture, and how to describe where things are. Session 16 moves outside to your neighborhood and introduces five high-frequency irregular verbs that appear in almost every Spanish conversation.

By the end of this week, you should be able to describe your home and neighborhood in 5–6 spoken sentences, combining vocabulary, prepositions, and the new verbs in real output.

What You Will Be Able to Say by the End of Week 8

Describing your home:

Vivo en un piso en el centro. Hay tres habitaciones: el salón, la cocina y el dormitorio. No hay jardín pero hay una terraza pequeña. El sofá está delante de la televisión. El armario está al lado de la cama.

Describing your neighborhood:

Mi barrio es tranquilo y muy cómodo. Hay una panadería al final de la calle y un parque cerca de casa. Cojo el metro para ir al trabajo — la estación está a cinco minutos andando. Conozco bien mi barrio. Sé dónde está todo.

Hay — The Essential Phrase

Hay means "there is" or "there are." It is always the same form — it never changes for singular or plural:

- Hay una habitación.* — There is one bedroom.
- Hay tres habitaciones.* — There are three bedrooms.
- No hay garaje.* — There isn't a garage.

Negation: *No hay* — simply add *no* before *hay*. No extra *de* needed (unlike French *il n'y a pas de*).

Hay vs. Estar — An Important Distinction

Both *hay* and *estar* talk about things in space, but they do different jobs:

	Use	Example
<i>Hay</i>	Existence — introduces something for the first time	<i>Hay un parque cerca de aquí.</i>
<i>Está / están</i>	Location — places a known, specific thing	<i>El parque está al lado del colegio.</i>

In a home description, you will use both:

- *Hay un sofá en el salón.* — There is a sofa in the living room. (introducing it)
- *El sofá está delante de la televisión.* — The sofa is in front of the TV. (locating it)

Both sentences are correct — they do different things.

Prepositions of Place

Spanish	English
encima de	on / on top of
debajo de	under
delante de	in front of
detrás de	behind
entre	between
al lado de	next to
al fondo de	at the far end of
enfrente de	opposite / facing

De + el = del (mandatory contraction):

- *al lado **del** salón* (de + el salón)
- *encima **del** armario* (de + el armario)
- *al fondo **del** pasillo* (de + el pasillo)

You already know *a + el = al* from Week 5. The same logic applies: *de + el = del*.

The Five Irregular Verbs This Week

Hacer (to do / to make)

yo	tú	él/ella	nosotros	vosotros	ellos/ellas
hago	haces	hace	hacemos	hacéis	hacen

Only yo is irregular. *Hace calor / frío / sol.* — It's hot / cold / sunny.

Venir (to come)

yo	tú	él/ella	nosotros	vosotros	ellos/ellas
vengo	vienes	viene	venimos	venís	vienen

Vengo de México. — I'm from Mexico. *¿A qué hora vienes?* — What time are you coming?

Decir (to say / to tell)

yo	tú	él/ella	nosotros	vosotros	ellos/ellas
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digo	dices	dice	decimos	decís	dicen
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¿Cómo se dice "bookshelf" en español? — How do you say "bookshelf" in Spanish?

Saber (to know a fact or skill)

yo	tú	él/ella	nosotros	vosotros	ellos/ellas
sé	sabes	sabe	sabemos	sabéis	saben

Sé dónde está el parque. — I know where the park is. No sé. — I don't know.

Conocer (to know / be familiar with)

yo	tú	él/ella	nosotros	vosotros	ellos/ellas
conozco	conoces	conoce	conocemos	conocéis	conocen

Conozco Madrid muy bien. — I know Madrid well. ¿Conoces a Juan? — Do you know Juan?

Saber vs. Conocer — One Minute Explanation

Use <i>saber</i> for...	Use <i>conocer</i> for...
facts (<i>Sé que vive aquí</i>)	people (<i>Conozco a María</i>)
skills (<i>Sé nadar</i>)	places (<i>¿Conoces Buenos Aires?</i>)
information (<i>¿Sabes qué hora es?</i>)	familiarity (<i>Conozco bien este barrio</i>)

Key rule: *Conocer* can only take a noun (a person or place). *Saber* can take a *que* clause or an infinitive. If you're about to say "I know **that**..." → *saber*.

What to Practice Between Sessions

After Session 15 — before Session 16:

1. **Say *hay* for your home.** *Hay [X] habitaciones. Hay... No hay...* — 4–5 sentences, no notes on the third try.
2. **Practice one preposition.** Pick one room and place 3 items in it: *El sofá está delante del televisor. La estantería está al lado de la ventana.*
3. **Learn the difference.** *Hay un armario en el dormitorio.* (existence) → *El armario está al lado de la cama.* (location). Say both for one room.

After Session 16 — before Session 17:

1. **Write your home and neighborhood description.** 5–7 sentences. Use *hay*, *estar* + preposition, *hacer*, *venir*, and one of *saber/conocer*.
2. **Say it without notes.** Third try.
3. **Learn *no sé*.** The most useful phrase you will say in Spanish this week. Say it until it is completely automatic.